

THE DISCRETIZATION STEP IN BUX–KASSMANN–SCHULZE: A GAP AND A REPAIR BY RANDOM LATTICE SAMPLING

CLAUDE

ABSTRACT. Bux, Kassmann and Schulze prove that quadratic forms whose kernels are non-degenerate only on double cones of arbitrary orientation are comparable, on every ball, to the Gagliardo seminorm of $H^{\alpha/2}$. Their proof passes from a discrete comparability theorem on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ to the continuous one by a limit which, as written, requires the function to lie a priori in $H^{\alpha/2}$ of a larger ball, which is what is to be proved. We explain the gap and close it along the paper’s own route. Instead of averaging the function over lattice cells, we sample it at the points of a randomly shifted and randomly distorted lattice, apply the discrete theorem to each lattice, and average over the lattices. This proves the enlarged-ball comparability for every measurable function, with no finiteness assumption, and with it all the continuous results of the paper. The argument has been checked in Lean 4.

1. INTRODUCTION

We use the notation of Bux, Kassmann and Schulze [1], and cite the numbering of the arXiv version [1]. A *double cone* with axis a unit vector $v \in \mathbb{R}^d$ and apex angle $\theta \in (0, \pi/2]$ is

$$V = \{ u \in \mathbb{R}^d \setminus \{0\} : |\langle u, v \rangle| > \cos \theta |u| \},$$

the set of nonzero vectors making an angle less than θ with the line $\mathbb{R}v$. A *configuration* Γ assigns to each $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$ a double cone $\Gamma(x)$, and $V^\Gamma[x] = x + \Gamma(x)$. It is ϑ -*bounded* if all apex angles are at least $\vartheta > 0$.¹ Let $\alpha \in (0, 2)$ and $\Lambda \geq 1$. We consider measurable $k: \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ with $k(x, y) = k(y, x)$ and

$$(1) \quad \Lambda^{-1}(\mathbf{1}_{V^\Gamma[x]}(y) + \mathbf{1}_{V^\Gamma[y]}(x))|x - y|^{-d-\alpha} \leq k(x, y) \leq \Lambda|x - y|^{-d-\alpha} \quad (x \neq y).$$

This is condition (2) of [1]. For a set $D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d$ and $f: \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ write

$$|f|_{H_k(D)}^2 = \iint_{D \times D} (f(y) - f(x))^2 k(x, y) \, dx \, dy, \quad |f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(D)}^2 = \iint_{D \times D} \frac{(f(y) - f(x))^2}{|x - y|^{d+\alpha}} \, dx \, dy,$$

with values in $[0, \infty]$.

The main result of [1], Theorem 1.1, is that for a ϑ -admissible Γ (see Section 4) there is c , depending only on d , ϑ and Λ , such that $|f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(B)}^2 \leq c|f|_{H_k(B)}^2$ for every ball B and every $f \in L^2(B)$. The proof has three steps.

- (1) A discrete analogue on $\mathbb{Z}^d$, Theorem 1.3 of [1], restated in Section 3.1. It is the heart of the paper.
- (2) The passage from the discrete to the continuous setting, in §3.2 of [1] (proof of Lemma 3.7). It yields the *enlarged-ball* inequality $c|f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(B)}^2 \leq |f|_{H_k(B^*)}^2$, with $B = B_R(x_0)$ and $B^* = B_{\kappa R}(x_0)$.

Date: September 2026.

¹[1] phrase this with the infimum of the apex angles; only the positive lower bound is ever used. We read “apex angle” as the angle to the axis. Nothing below depends on this reading beyond the value of the constants.

- (3) The removal of the enlargement, Lemma A.1 of [1], via a Whitney decomposition and an inequality of Dyda [3].

Step 2 contains a gap, described in Section 2. As written, the limit $h \rightarrow 0$ on the kernel side of the discretized inequality is justified by dominated convergence. That step needs $f \in H^{\alpha/2}(B^*)$, while the lemma is applied, and must be applied, to every $f \in H_k(B^*)$.

Our main result closes the gap. It uses nothing from [1] beyond Theorem 1.3.

Theorem A. *Let $d \geq 1$, $\vartheta \in (0, \pi/2]$, $\Lambda \geq 1$ and $\alpha \in (0, 2)$. There are $\kappa \geq 1$ and $C < \infty$, depending only on d , ϑ , Λ and α , with the following property. Let Γ be a ϑ -bounded configuration, which need not satisfy any measurability condition. Let k be measurable, symmetric and satisfy (1), and let $f: \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be measurable. Then for every ball $B = B_R(x_0)$,*

$$|f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(B_R(x_0))}^2 \leq C |f|_{H_k(B_{\kappa R}(x_0))}^2.$$

No finiteness of either side is assumed. This is exactly the enlarged-ball inequality that Step 2 is meant to provide, now for every measurable f , so Steps 1 and 3 complete the proof of Theorem 1.1 of [1] (Section 4).

The idea. In [1] the function is replaced by its averages f_h over the cells of $h\mathbb{Z}^d$. The averages destroy the oscillation of f inside a cell, and recovering the continuous form in the limit is what requires domination. We instead *sample* f at the points of a lattice. Sampling keeps every difference $f(s) - f(t)$ between lattice points exactly, so the discrete theorem applies to the sampled function for every lattice, with no limit to take. The lattice is then made random, by a shift $\eta \in [-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}]^d$ and a small linear distortion $A = I + E$. Averaging the discrete inequality over the lattices reproduces both continuous forms, up to constants and up to pairs at distance $O(h)$. The random shift alone would sample only differences in directions of $h\mathbb{Z}^d$; the random distortion spreads the differences over all directions.

Related work. Chaker and Silvestre [2, Theorem 1.3] prove a localized coercivity estimate, $\iint_{B_2 \times B_2} (u(x) - u(y))^2 K \geq c\lambda |u|_{\dot{H}^s(B_1)}^2$ for every u , under a condition on the density of the nondegeneracy set of the kernel. They remark that their result implies that of [1]. Their method is different: an iteration on kernels with a covering argument, not a discretization. So the continuous conclusions of [1] were already available through [2]. The point of the present note is that the discretization route of [1], through their Theorem 1.3, can itself be completed. We are not aware of any earlier discussion of the gap.

Formal verification. Theorem A and every lemma below have been formalized and checked in Lean 4 with Mathlib (Section 5). The formalization also proves Theorem 1.3 of [1] itself.

2. THE GAP

We follow the proof of Lemma 3.7 of [1] (pp. 14–16). Let $f \in H_k(B^*)$. For $h \in (0, 1)$ let $f_h(x) = h^{-d} \int_{A_h(x) \cap B^*} f$ for $x \in h\mathbb{Z}^d \cap B^*$, where $A_h(x)$ is the cell of side h about x . Theorem 1.3, applied to f_h and a discretized kernel ω_h^k , gives the discrete inequality (15) of [1]:

$$\begin{aligned} c \sum_{\substack{x, y \in B \cap h\mathbb{Z}^d \\ |x-y| > \sqrt{d}h}} (f_h(x) - f_h(y))^2 \int_{A_h(x) \times A_h(y)} |s-t|^{-d-\alpha} d(s, t) \\ \leq \sum_{\substack{x, y \in B^* \cap h\mathbb{Z}^d \\ |x-y| > \sqrt{d}h}} (f_h(x) - f_h(y))^2 \int_{A_h(x) \times A_h(y)} k(s, t) d(s, t). \end{aligned}$$

The right-hand side is $\int g_h$, where $g_h(s, t) = (f_h(x) - f_h(y))^2 k(s, t)$ for $(s, t) \in \tilde{A}_h(x) \times \tilde{A}_h(y)$ with x, y as in the sum, and $g_h = 0$ otherwise. By Lebesgue differentiation (their Lemma A.2), $g_h \rightarrow g = (f(s) - f(t))^2 k(s, t) \mathbf{1}_{B^* \times B^*}$ almost everywhere. The proof then states, on p. 16:

“For the right hand side in (15) this implies with help of dominated convergence $[\int g_h \rightarrow \int g]$.”

No dominating function is given, and none is available from the hypothesis $f \in H_k(B^*)$.

The only upper bound on g_h comes from Jensen’s inequality,

$$(f_h(x) - f_h(y))^2 \leq h^{-2d} \int_{A_h(x) \times A_h(y)} (f(s') - f(t'))^2 d(s', t'),$$

together with the upper bound in (1), $k(s, t) \leq \Lambda |s - t|^{-d-\alpha} \lesssim |s' - t'|^{-d-\alpha}$. This bounds g_h by local averages of $(f(s') - f(t'))^2 |s' - t'|^{-d-\alpha}$. Any integrable majorant built this way requires at least $f \in H^{\alpha/2}(B^*)$, which is the conclusion being proved.

The hypothesis controls $(f(s) - f(t))^2 k(s, t)$, and this cannot be used here. The function g_h pairs the value $k(s, t)$ with differences of *averages* of f over the two cells, and the lower bound in (1) controls k only on the cones. The kernel may vanish at (s', t') while being of full size at (s, t) in the same pair of cells.

Nor can the step be rescued cheaply:

- Restricting to $f \in H^{\alpha/2}(B^*)$ makes the step valid, but then the resulting inequality holds only for such f . It does not yield the inclusion $H_k(B) \subseteq H^{\alpha/2}(B)$, which is the content of Lemma 3.7.
- Approximating $f \in H_k(B^*)$ by smooth functions in the H_k norm would require the density statement of Theorem 1.4, whose proof uses Lemma 3.7.

The final inequality of Lemma 3.7 is true, by Theorem A or by [2]. But its proof in [1] is incomplete at this step.

3. PROOF OF THEOREM A

Throughout, $d \geq 1$, $|\cdot|$ is the Euclidean norm and $|\cdot|_\infty$ the maximum norm, and $|\cdot|$ also denotes Lebesgue measure. Balls $B_r(x)$ are open and $\bar{B}_r(x)$ closed. Integrals of $[0, \infty]$ -valued functions are Lebesgue integrals, and all identities and inequalities are between elements of $[0, \infty]$.

3.1. The discrete theorem.

Theorem 1.3 of [1]. *Let Γ be a ϑ -bounded configuration and $\alpha \in (0, 2)$. Let $\omega: \mathbb{Z}^d \times \mathbb{Z}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ satisfy $\omega(x, y) = \omega(y, x)$ and*

$$\Lambda^{-1}(\mathbf{1}_{V_\Gamma[x]}(y) + \mathbf{1}_{V_\Gamma[y]}(x)) |x - y|^{-d-\alpha} \leq \omega(x, y) \leq \Lambda |x - y|^{-d-\alpha}$$

for $|x - y| > R_0$, where $R_0 > 0$ and $\Lambda \geq 1$. There are $\kappa \geq 1$ and $c \geq 1$ such that for every $R > 0$, every $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}^d$ and every $f: B_{\kappa R}(x_0) \cap \mathbb{Z}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$,

$$\sum_{\substack{x, y \in B_R(x_0) \cap \mathbb{Z}^d \\ |x - y| > R_0}} (f(x) - f(y))^2 |x - y|^{-d-\alpha} \leq c \sum_{\substack{x, y \in B_{\kappa R}(x_0) \cap \mathbb{Z}^d \\ |x - y| > R_0}} (f(x) - f(y))^2 \omega(x, y).$$

The constants depend on Λ , ϑ , R_0 and d , and not on ω or Γ .

We use it with $R_0 = \frac{1}{2}$. Then the condition $|x - y| > R_0$ holds for all distinct lattice points, and the sums run over all pairs of distinct points, or all pairs, since diagonal terms vanish.

3.2. Random lattices. Fix

$$\varepsilon = \min\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2} \sin(\vartheta/2)\right), \quad \delta = \varepsilon/d.$$

For $Q = (Q_1, \dots, Q_d) \in (\mathbb{R}^d)^d$ let A_Q be the linear map $A_Q u = u + \sum_j u_j Q_j$, and let $\mathcal{Q}_\delta = \bar{B}_\delta(0)^d \subseteq (\mathbb{R}^d)^d$. For $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_\delta$, $|A_Q u - u| \leq \sum_j |u_j| \delta \leq d\delta|u| = \varepsilon|u|$. Hence

$$(2) \quad (1 - \varepsilon)|u| \leq |A_Q u| \leq (1 + \varepsilon)|u|, \quad (1 - \varepsilon)^d \leq |\det A_Q| \leq (1 + \varepsilon)^d,$$

the second because the singular values of A_Q lie in $[1 - \varepsilon, 1 + \varepsilon]$. Let $P = [-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}]^d$. For $h > 0$, $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_\delta$ and $\eta \in P$, the lattice map is

$$T(z) = T_{h,Q,\eta}(z) = h A_Q(z + \eta) \quad (z \in \mathbb{Z}^d),$$

an injective affine map.

3.3. One lattice.

Lemma 3.1 (Cones). *Let V be a double cone with axis v and apex angle $\theta \geq \vartheta$, and let V' be the double cone with the same axis and apex angle $\theta/2$. Let A be linear with $|Au - u| \leq \varepsilon|u|$ for all u , where $\varepsilon < \sin(\vartheta/2)$. Then $AV' \subseteq V$.*

Proof. Let $w \in V'$, so w makes an angle less than $\theta/2$ with v or with $-v$. Since $|Aw - w| \leq \varepsilon|w|$ and $\varepsilon < 1$, $Aw \neq 0$, and the angle between Aw and w is at most $\arcsin \varepsilon < \vartheta/2 \leq \theta/2$. By the triangle inequality for angles, Aw makes an angle less than θ with the same half-line, so $Aw \in V$. $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (The inequality for one lattice). *Let κ_0 and c_0 be the constants of Theorem 1.3 of [1] for the parameters $\vartheta/2$, $\Lambda' = 2^{d+\alpha}\Lambda$ and $R_0 = \frac{1}{2}$. Let Γ be ϑ -bounded, let k be symmetric and satisfy (1), and let $f: \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be any function. Write*

$$F(s, t) = (f(t) - f(s))^2 |s - t|^{-d-\alpha}, \quad G(s, t) = (f(t) - f(s))^2 k(s, t),$$

and $F_D = F \mathbf{1}_{D \times D}$, $G_D = G \mathbf{1}_{D \times D}$. Then for every ball $B = B_R(x_0)$, every $h > 0$, $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_\delta$ and $\eta \in P$, with $T = T_{h,Q,\eta}$ and $B^* = B_{3\kappa_0 R}(x_0)$,

$$\sum_{z, z' \in \mathbb{Z}^d} F_B(Tz, Tz') \leq 2^{d+\alpha} c_0 \sum_{z, z' \in \mathbb{Z}^d} G_{B^*}(Tz, Tz').$$

Proof. Write $A = A_Q$.

The pulled-back configuration. Let $\Gamma'(z)$ be the double cone with the axis of $\Gamma(Tz)$ and half its apex angle. Then Γ' is $\vartheta/2$ -bounded. If $z' \in V^{\Gamma'}[z]$, then $Tz' - Tz = hA(z' - z) \in \Gamma(Tz)$ by Lemma 3.1, since double cones are invariant under positive dilations. Hence $\mathbf{1}_{V^{\Gamma'}[z]}(z') \leq \mathbf{1}_{V^{\Gamma}[Tz]}(Tz')$.

The pulled-back kernel. Let $\omega(z, z') = h^{d+\alpha} k(Tz, Tz')$, which is symmetric. By (2), $h(1 - \varepsilon)|z - z'| \leq |Tz - Tz'| \leq h(1 + \varepsilon)|z - z'|$. With $\varepsilon \leq \frac{1}{2}$, (1) gives, for $z \neq z'$,

$$\omega(z, z') \leq \Lambda(1 - \varepsilon)^{-d-\alpha} |z - z'|^{-d-\alpha} \leq \Lambda' |z - z'|^{-d-\alpha},$$

and

$$\omega(z, z') \geq \Lambda^{-1}(1 + \varepsilon)^{-d-\alpha} (\mathbf{1}_{V^{\Gamma'}[z]}(z') + \mathbf{1}_{V^{\Gamma'}[z']}(z)) |z - z'|^{-d-\alpha},$$

with $\Lambda^{-1}(1 + \varepsilon)^{-d-\alpha} \geq \Lambda'^{-1}$. These bounds hold at every pair of lattice points, because (1) holds at every pair of points; no measurability of Γ enters. So (Γ', ω) satisfies the hypotheses of Theorem 1.3 of [1] with $\vartheta/2$, Λ' and $R_0 = \frac{1}{2}$.

The balls. Let $c = T^{-1}x_0$ and $r = R/(h(1-\varepsilon))$. If $Tz \in B$ then $|z-c| \leq |Tz-x_0|/(h(1-\varepsilon)) < r$, so $z \in B_r(c)$. If $z \in B_{\kappa_0 r}(c)$ then $|Tz-x_0| < h(1+\varepsilon)\kappa_0 r = \kappa_0 R(1+\varepsilon)/(1-\varepsilon) \leq 3\kappa_0 R$, so $Tz \in B^*$.

Conclusion. Apply Theorem 1.3 of [1] to $f \circ T$ on $B_r(c)$. Using $|Tz - Tz'|^{-d-\alpha} \leq 2^{d+\alpha} h^{-d-\alpha} |z - z'|^{-d-\alpha}$ on the left,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{z, z'} F_B(Tz, Tz') &\leq 2^{d+\alpha} h^{-d-\alpha} \sum_{z, z' \in B_r(c)} (f(Tz) - f(Tz'))^2 |z - z'|^{-d-\alpha} \\ &\leq 2^{d+\alpha} c_0 h^{-d-\alpha} \sum_{z, z' \in B_{\kappa_0 r}(c)} (f(Tz) - f(Tz'))^2 \omega(z, z'). \end{aligned}$$

The last sum is $h^{d+\alpha} \sum_{z, z' \in B_{\kappa_0 r}(c)} G(Tz, Tz')$, and every such pair has $Tz, Tz' \in B^*$. $\square$

3.4. Averaging over lattices. For measurable $H: \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ put

$$L_h(H) = \int_{\mathcal{Q}_\delta} \int_P \sum_{z, z' \in \mathbb{Z}^d} H(T_{h,Q,\eta} z, T_{h,Q,\eta} z') d\eta dQ.$$

Here dQ is Lebesgue measure on $(\mathbb{R}^d)^d$, and the integrand is jointly measurable in (Q, η) .

Lemma 3.3 (Tiling). *Let H be measurable, nonnegative and zero on the diagonal. For $h > 0$ and $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_\delta$,*

$$\int_P \sum_{z, z'} H(Tz, Tz') d\eta = |\det(hA_Q)|^{-1} \sum_{w \in \mathbb{Z}^d \setminus \{0\}} \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} H(s, s + hA_Q w) ds.$$

Proof. Write $z' = z + w$. The term $w = 0$ vanishes. For fixed w , the translates $z + P$, $z \in \mathbb{Z}^d$, tile $\mathbb{R}^d$, so $\sum_z \int_P H(hA(z + \eta), hA(z + \eta) + hAw) d\eta = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} H(hAu, hAu + hAw) du$. The substitution $s = hAu$ finishes the proof. All terms are nonnegative, so sums and integrals may be interchanged. $\square$

Lemma 3.4 (Averaging a column). *Let $g: \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be measurable and $w \in \mathbb{Z}^d \setminus \{0\}$, with $m = |w|_\infty$. Then*

$$|B_{\delta/d}|^{d-1} m^{-d} \int_{\bar{B}_{\delta m/d}(w)} g \leq \int_{\mathcal{Q}_\delta} g(A_Q w) dQ \leq |B_\delta|^{d-1} m^{-d} \int_{\bar{B}_{\delta m}(w)} g.$$

Proof. Choose j with $|w_j| = m$. Fix the columns Q_i , $i \neq j$, and put $c = w + \sum_{i \neq j} w_i Q_i$, so that $A_Q w = c + w_j Q_j$. The substitution $y = c + w_j Q_j$ gives $\int_{\bar{B}_\delta(0)} g(c + w_j Q_j) dQ_j = m^{-d} \int_{\bar{B}_{\delta m}(c)} g$.

For the upper bound, $|c - w| \leq (d-1)\delta m$, so $\bar{B}_{\delta m}(c) \subseteq \bar{B}_{\delta m}(w)$. Integrating over the other $d-1$ columns gives the factor $|B_\delta|^{d-1}$.

For the lower bound, restrict the other columns to $\bar{B}_{\delta/d}(0)$. Then $|c - w| \leq (d-1)\delta m/d$ and $\bar{B}_{\delta m}(c) \supseteq \bar{B}_{\delta m/d}(w)$, and the restricted columns contribute $|B_{\delta/d}|^{d-1}$. $\square$

Lemma 3.5 (Counting). *For $y \in \mathbb{R}^d$ put $\rho^+(y) = \sum_{w \neq 0} |w|_\infty^{-d} \mathbf{1}[|y - w| \leq d\delta |w|_\infty]$ and $\rho^-(y) = \sum_{w \neq 0} |w|_\infty^{-d} \mathbf{1}[|y - w| \leq \delta |w|_\infty/d]$, the sums over $w \in \mathbb{Z}^d \setminus \{0\}$. Then*

- (1) $\rho^+(y) \leq 6^d$ for all y ;
- (2) $\rho^-(y) \geq (\delta/(3d^2))^d$ whenever $|y| \geq C_0 := 2d^3/\delta$.

Proof. (1) If w contributes, then $|y - w|_\infty \leq |y - w| \leq d\delta |w|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{2}|w|_\infty$. Hence $\frac{1}{2}|w|_\infty \leq |y|_\infty \leq \frac{3}{2}|w|_\infty$. Since $|w|_\infty \geq 1$, this forces $|y|_\infty \geq \frac{1}{2}$. The contributing w lie in the cube

$\{|w - y|_\infty \leq |y|_\infty\}$, which contains at most $(2|y|_\infty + 1)^d \leq (4|y|_\infty)^d$ lattice points. Each has weight $|w|_\infty^{-d} \leq (\frac{3}{2}|y|_\infty)^d$. So $\rho^+(y) \leq 6^d$.

(2) Let $M = |y|_\infty \geq |y|/\sqrt{d} \geq |y|/d \geq 2d^2/\delta$, and $r = \delta M/(2d^2) \geq 1$. Since $\delta \leq 1$, also $r \leq M/2$. Consider $w \in \mathbb{Z}^d$ with $|w - y|_\infty \leq r$. Then $\frac{1}{2}M \leq |w|_\infty \leq \frac{3}{2}M$, in particular $w \neq 0$, and

$$|y - w| \leq \sqrt{d}r \leq dr = \delta M/(2d) \leq \delta|w|_\infty/d,$$

so w contributes at least $(\frac{3}{2}M)^{-d}$. Each coordinate interval $[y_i - r, y_i + r]$ contains at least $\lfloor 2r \rfloor \geq r$ integers, since $r \geq 1$. So there are at least r^d such w , and $\rho^-(y) \geq r^d(\frac{3}{2}M)^{-d} = (\delta/(3d^2))^d$. $\square$

Proposition 3.6 (The lattice average). *Let $H: \mathbb{R}^d \times \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty]$ be measurable and zero on the diagonal. For every $h > 0$,*

$$K_- h^{-2d} \iint_{|t-s| \geq C_0 h} H(s, t) \, ds \, dt \leq L_h(H) \leq K_+ h^{-2d} \iint H(s, t) \, ds \, dt,$$

with $K_+ = 6^d |B_\delta|^{d-1} (1 - \varepsilon)^{-d}$, $K_- = (\delta/(3d^2))^d |B_{\delta/d}|^{d-1} (1 + \varepsilon)^{-d}$ and C_0 as in Lemma 3.5.

Proof. By Lemma 3.3, (2) and Tonelli's theorem,

$$L_h(H) \leq h^{-d} (1 - \varepsilon)^{-d} \sum_{w \neq 0} \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \int_{Q_\delta} H(s, s + hA_Q w) \, dQ \, ds.$$

Apply Lemma 3.4 with $g(y) = H(s, s + hy)$, and then sum over w :

$$L_h(H) \leq h^{-d} (1 - \varepsilon)^{-d} |B_\delta|^{d-1} \iint H(s, s + hy) \rho^+(y) \, dy \, ds.$$

By Lemma 3.5(1) and the substitution $t = s + hy$, for which $\int H(s, s + hy) \, dy = h^{-d} \int H(s, t) \, dt$, this is at most $K_+ h^{-2d} \iint H$.

The lower bound is the same computation, with the lower halves of (2) and Lemma 3.4. Discarding $|y| < C_0$ and using Lemma 3.5(2) gives

$$L_h(H) \geq h^{-d} (1 + \varepsilon)^{-d} |B_{\delta/d}|^{d-1} \left(\frac{\delta}{3d^2} \right)^d \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \int_{|y| \geq C_0} H(s, s + hy) \, dy \, ds,$$

and the substitution $t = s + hy$ turns $\{|y| \geq C_0\}$ into $\{|t - s| \geq C_0 h\}$. $\square$

3.5. Conclusion.

Proof of Theorem A. The case $d = 0$ is trivial; let $d \geq 1$. With κ_0, c_0 as in Lemma 3.2, put $\kappa = 3\kappa_0$ and $B^* = B_{\kappa R}(x_0)$. Since f and k are measurable, F_B and G_{B^*} are measurable, and both vanish on the diagonal. Lemma 3.2 holds for every (h, Q, η) . Integrating it over $\eta \in P$ and $Q \in \mathcal{Q}_\delta$ gives $L_h(F_B) \leq 2^{d+\alpha} c_0 L_h(G_{B^*})$. By Proposition 3.6,

$$K_- \iint_{|t-s| \geq C_0 h} F_B \leq 2^{d+\alpha} c_0 K_+ \iint G_{B^*} \quad (h > 0).$$

As $h \downarrow 0$ the sets $\{|t - s| \geq C_0 h\}$ increase to the complement of the diagonal, a null set. By monotone convergence,

$$|f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(B)}^2 = \iint F_B \leq \frac{2^{d+\alpha} c_0 K_+}{K_-} \iint G_{B^*} = C |f|_{H_k(B^*)}^2.$$

The constants $\varepsilon, \delta, K_\pm, C_0$ depend only on d and ϑ , and κ_0, c_0 only on d, ϑ, Λ and α . $\square$

Remark 3.7. If the constants of Theorem 1.3 of [1] can be chosen independently of $\alpha \in (0, 2)$, as its statement in [1] suggests, then so can κ and C . Use $\Lambda' = 2^{d+2}\Lambda$ in Lemma 3.2, and $2^{d+\alpha} \leq 2^{d+2}$. The formalization proves Theorem 1.3 of [1] in this uniform form.

4. CONSEQUENCES

A configuration is ϑ -admissible in [1] if it is ϑ -bounded and $\{(x, y) : y - x \in \Gamma(x)\}$ is Borel (condition (M)). Theorem A does not use (M).

Corollary 4.1. *Lemma 3.7, Theorem 1.1, and the comparability statements of Theorem 1.4 of [1] hold as stated.*

Proof. In the proof of Lemma 3.7, the passage in Section 2 is meant to establish $c|f|_{H^{\alpha/2}(B)}^2 \leq |f|_{H_k(B^*)}^2$ for all $f \in H_k(B^*)$ and every ball, with c independent of the ball. Theorem A gives this for every $f \in L^2(B^*)$: take a measurable representative, extended by zero, and note that both sides depend only on the values of f on B^* . The rest of the proof of Lemma 3.7 in [1] is the application of their Lemma A.1, which removes the enlargement and is unaffected by the gap. Theorem 1.1 follows from Lemma 3.7 as in [1]. So do the comparabilities in Theorem 1.4: on $\mathbb{R}^d$ by letting the radius tend to infinity, and on bounded Lipschitz domains through Lemma A.1. $\square$

The dependence on α_0 asserted in Theorem 1.1 follows from Remark 3.7 and the corresponding statement of Lemma A.1.

5. FORMALIZATION

The argument above is checked in Lean 4 with Mathlib, as part of a formalization of [1]. The repository is <https://github.com/dbenbenn/quadratic-forms-sobolev-lean>, in the directory QuadraticFormsSobolev/RandomLattice. The correspondence is:

Theorem A	QFS.formHs_ball_le_form_ball_randomLattice
Lemma 3.1	QFS.mem_doubleCone_of_near
Lemma 3.2	QFS.latticeSum_ball_le
Lemma 3.3	QFS.lintegral_latticeSum_le, QFS.le_lintegral_latticeSum
Lemma 3.4	QFS.lintegral_colBox_le, QFS.le_lintegral_colBox
Lemma 3.5	QFS.tsum_count_le, QFS.le_tsum_count
Proposition 3.6	QFS.latAvg_le, QFS.le_latAvg
Theorem 1.3 of [1]	QFS.theoremOneThree, QFS.theoremOneThree_uniform

Some constants in the formalization differ harmlessly from those above; for example, it has 4^d in Lemma 3.5(1).

The formalization also proves Theorem 1.3 of [1] in full, in the α -uniform form of Remark 3.7, and Theorem 1.1 with the α_0 clause. The statement of Theorem 1.3 is correct as printed. A few steps of its printed proof needed local repairs in the formalization; they are independent of the gap discussed here and are not treated in this note. For the step removing the enlargement, it gives a proof of Lemma A.1 that avoids the Whitney decomposition, with Dyda’s inequality proved rather than quoted. All results depend only on the standard axioms (`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`).

REFERENCES

- [1] K.-U. Bux, M. Kassmann, and T. Schulze, *Quadratic forms and Sobolev spaces of fractional order*, Proc. London Math. Soc. (3) **119** (2019), 841–866, doi:10.1112/plms.12246. Cited from [arXiv:1707.09277v1](https://arxiv.org/abs/1707.09277v1), whose numbering and page numbers we use; we were unable to consult the journal version.

- [2] J. Chaker and L. Silvestre, *Coercivity estimates for integro-differential operators*, Calc. Var. Partial Differential Equations **59** (2020), Paper No. 106, [doi:10.1007/s00526-020-01764-y](https://doi.org/10.1007/s00526-020-01764-y), [arXiv:1904.13014](https://arxiv.org/abs/1904.13014).
- [3] B. Dyda, *On comparability of integral forms*, J. Math. Anal. Appl. **318** (2006), 564–577, [doi:10.1016/j.jmaa.2005.06.021](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jmaa.2005.06.021).

About this note. This note was written by Claude, an AI model made by Anthropic. The mathematics in it was developed and machine-checked in the Lean formalization cited in Section 5.

ANTHROPIC